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Minimum e-scooter riding age set at 15

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE has set a minimum age of 15 for obtaining an electric scooter riding permit from January 1, 2027, under new traffic regulations that also require permits, registration and stricter safety standards for personal mobility devices.

The new executive regulations also prohibit riders from using roads designated for motor vehicles, restricting them to routes approved by the authorities.

The regulations of the UAE Traffic and Road Law establish a comprehensive framework governing the use of personal mobility devices on public roads, classifying them into six categories and setting out rules for their registration, operation and use on designated routes.

Permit valid for 3 years

Under the new regulations, riders must be at least 15 years old to apply for permits covering electric scooters, electric bicycles and small motorised bikes. The permits will be valid for three years and can be renewed.

The six categories covered by the regulations are conventional bicycles, electric bicycles, electric scooters, small motorised bikes, skateboards and mobility devices designed for elderly people and people with disabilities.

SEE ALSO P2



UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT LEADS FLAG DAY CELEBRATIONS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan raised the UAE flag at Qasr Al Hosn in Abu Dhabi to mark Flag Day. The ceremony was attended by 55 accomplished and talented individuals from various sectors, representing the 55 years since the establishment of the UAE. SEE ALSO P4, PII

Deal hopes still alive despite US strikes on Iran

QATAR OPTIMISTIC ABOUT PEACE TALKS, TEHRAN VOICES 'PESSIMISM'

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Hopes of a US-Iran peace agreement remained alive yesterday despite fresh American strikes on Qeshm Island, with Qatar expressing optimism about ongoing negotiations even as Tehran said it was approaching diplomacy with "complete pessimism".

The diplomatic push unfolded as Americans voted in crucial midterm elections, following Trump's threats to launch renewed strikes on Iran after the polls.

Qatar, a key mediator in the eight-month-old conflict, said Washington and Tehran remained committed to negotiations and were reviewing proposals aimed at breaking the deadlock.

"Both parties remain committed to the negotiation process," foreign ministry spokesman Majed Al Ansari said, confirming that Doha was facilitating the exchange of proposals. "We remain hopeful that there is still a chance for a deal to take place," he added, saying Qatar was working towards an interim agreement.

The diplomatic push continued despite US strikes on Qeshm Island in the Strait of Hormuz, which President Donald Trump confirmed yesterday. "They built an anti-aircraft facility... As soon as it was completed, we hit it last night very nicely," Trump told Fox News, describing the operation as a "minor attack".

Progress made

Before the strikes, Vice President J.D. Vance had expressed optimism about negotiations, saying on Monday that Washington had made progress towards a settlement.

"We've certainly made some progress. We'll see if we can make some more," he said.

However, Iran's Foreign Ministry said Tehran was entering negotiations with "complete pessimism", although it remained willing to participate in diplomatic efforts.

Mohsen Rezaei, secretary of Iran's Supreme National Security Council, said Washington's response to Tehran's demands was unconvincing.

He insisted that the US must fully address and act on all seven Iranian conditions before the Strait of Hormuz could reopen.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian warned that a return to war would benefit nobody, saying his government was seeking a diplomatic solution. But chief negotiator Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf warned that Iran remained ready "for battle with its finger on the trigger".

Meanwhile, an Indian national was killed when an Indian-flagged vessel was struck by an unidentified aerial object off Oman.

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ABU DHABI

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